

Table 1: CEO Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	CashRatio						CashRatio_lead					
ClarityCEO	-0.0046* (0.0033)	-0.0071* (0.0051)	-0.0058** (0.0033)	-0.0054 (0.0048)	-0.0056** (0.0033)	-0.0052 (0.0047)	-0.0016 (0.0040)	-0.0169** (0.0082)	-0.0022 (0.0040)	-0.0169** (0.0080)	-0.0025 (0.0040)	-0.0168** (0.0080)
UncResCEO	0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0019** (0.0010)	0.0020** (0.0010)	0.0016* (0.0010)	0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0016* (0.0010)	0.0011 (0.0013)	0.0015 (0.0012)	0.0010 (0.0013)	0.0013 (0.0012)	0.0008 (0.0013)	0.0012 (0.0012)
UncPreCEO	0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0011)	0.0006 (0.0011)	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0007 (0.0011)	-0.0011 (0.0017)	0.0002 (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0017)	-0.0001 (0.0015)	-0.0017 (0.0017)	-0.0003 (0.0016)
Leverage	-0.0177*** (0.0048)	-0.0355*** (0.0084)	-0.0130*** (0.0036)	-0.0218*** (0.0082)	-0.0132*** (0.0037)	-0.0216*** (0.0082)	-0.0274*** (0.0102)	-0.0184* (0.0103)	-0.0266*** (0.0101)	-0.0123 (0.0102)	-0.0264*** (0.0100)	-0.0118 (0.0101)
lnAssets	-0.0015*** (0.0006)	-0.0177*** (0.0026)	-0.0017*** (0.0005)	-0.0175*** (0.0026)	-0.0014*** (0.0005)	-0.0170*** (0.0026)	-0.0019** (0.0008)	-0.0208*** (0.0036)	-0.0014* (0.0008)	-0.0210*** (0.0036)	-0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0212*** (0.0036)
TobinsQ	0.0058*** (0.0006)	0.0048*** (0.0009)	0.0042*** (0.0007)	0.0037*** (0.0010)	0.0040*** (0.0007)	0.0034*** (0.0010)	0.0058*** (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0043*** (0.0011)	-0.0003 (0.0014)	0.0044*** (0.0011)	0.0000 (0.0014)
ROA	-0.0144 (0.0093)	0.0214** (0.0105)	-0.0679*** (0.0113)	-0.0195 (0.0122)	-0.0630*** (0.0114)	-0.0171 (0.0122)	-0.0775*** (0.0130)	-0.0438*** (0.0168)	-0.0967*** (0.0139)	-0.0753*** (0.0173)	-0.0958*** (0.0139)	-0.0743*** (0.0174)
Capex	-0.1117*** (0.0128)	-0.2995*** (0.0234)	-0.1596*** (0.0149)	-0.3074*** (0.0236)	-0.1564*** (0.0148)	-0.2993*** (0.0234)	-0.0864*** (0.0154)	-0.2168*** (0.0290)	-0.1320*** (0.0171)	-0.2279*** (0.0293)	-0.1319*** (0.0172)	-0.2321*** (0.0295)
DivDummy	-0.0041*** (0.0013)	-0.0028 (0.0023)	-0.0054*** (0.0013)	-0.0041* (0.0022)	-0.0049*** (0.0013)	-0.0036 (0.0022)	-0.0033* (0.0019)	-0.0056 (0.0039)	-0.0028 (0.0019)	-0.0058 (0.0039)	-0.0030 (0.0019)	-0.0061 (0.0039)
sCFO	0.0066*** (0.0020)	-0.0022 (0.0014)	0.0079*** (0.0030)	-0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0074*** (0.0028)	-0.0009 (0.0014)	0.0112* (0.0059)	0.0033 (0.0022)	0.0097* (0.0051)	0.0036 (0.0023)	0.0097* (0.0051)	0.0036 (0.0023)
Lagged_DV	0.8558*** (0.0076)	0.6146*** (0.0133)	0.8612*** (0.0075)	0.6322*** (0.0130)	0.8617*** (0.0075)	0.6337*** (0.0130)	0.7831*** (0.0116)	0.3513*** (0.0182)	0.7750*** (0.0115)	0.3494*** (0.0181)	0.7756*** (0.0115)	0.3504*** (0.0181)
SalesGrowth			-0.0178*** (0.0045)	-0.0274*** (0.0052)	-0.0169*** (0.0044)	-0.0266*** (0.0052)			-0.0001 (0.0040)	-0.0065* (0.0034)	0.0002 (0.0040)	-0.0061* (0.0035)
RDSales			0.0062*** (0.0017)	-0.0032*** (0.0012)	0.0062*** (0.0017)	-0.0031** (0.0012)			0.0102*** (0.0022)	-0.0002 (0.0016)	0.0102*** (0.0022)	-0.0000 (0.0016)
CashFlowAt			0.1292*** (0.0162)	0.1589*** (0.0173)	0.1278*** (0.0162)	0.1576*** (0.0173)			0.0941*** (0.0164)	0.1143*** (0.0211)	0.0914*** (0.0164)	0.1117*** (0.0212)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001* (0.0000)			0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	43,333	43,333	43,316	43,316	43,316	43,316	41,853	41,853	41,839	41,839	41,839	41,839
R ²	0.825	0.431	0.829	0.449	0.830	0.449	0.713	0.167	0.715	0.175	0.716	0.175
Adj. R ²	0.825	0.412	0.829	0.430	0.830	0.430	0.713	0.139	0.715	0.147	0.716	0.146

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 2: Cash Holdings: Financial-Constraint Moderation

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio				CashRatio_lead			
ClarityCEO_c	-0.0062** (0.0034)	-0.0043 (0.0052)	-0.0059** (0.0034)	-0.0042 (0.0052)	-0.0009 (0.0042)	-0.0168** (0.0085)	-0.0011 (0.0042)	-0.0167** (0.0085)
UncResCEO_c	0.0020** (0.0011)	0.0018** (0.0010)	0.0022** (0.0011)	0.0019** (0.0010)	0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0014 (0.0013)	0.0007 (0.0014)	0.0013 (0.0013)
UncPreCEO_c	0.0002 (0.0012)	0.0005 (0.0012)	0.0003 (0.0012)	0.0007 (0.0012)	-0.0015 (0.0018)	-0.0006 (0.0016)	-0.0017 (0.0018)	-0.0008 (0.0017)
Unrated	0.0038*** (0.0012)	-0.0027 (0.0035)	-0.0010 (0.0016)	-0.0026 (0.0035)	0.0064*** (0.0020)	-0.0089* (0.0046)	0.0000 (0.0026)	-0.0091** (0.0046)
UncResCEO_c.x.Unrated	0.0011 (0.0021)	-0.0001 (0.0020)	0.0012 (0.0021)	-0.0000 (0.0020)	0.0041* (0.0027)	0.0031 (0.0025)	0.0040* (0.0026)	0.0031 (0.0024)
UncPreCEO_c.x.Unrated	0.0024 (0.0022)	0.0013 (0.0025)	0.0029* (0.0023)	0.0014 (0.0025)	-0.0011 (0.0033)	-0.0036 (0.0033)	-0.0010 (0.0033)	-0.0038 (0.0033)
Leverage	-0.0117*** (0.0033)	-0.0216** (0.0098)	-0.0141*** (0.0041)	-0.0214** (0.0099)	-0.0230** (0.0102)	-0.0073 (0.0114)	-0.0256** (0.0112)	-0.0068 (0.0113)
InAssets	0.0005* (0.0003)	-0.0159*** (0.0027)	-0.0019*** (0.0007)	-0.0155*** (0.0027)	0.0019*** (0.0005)	-0.0226*** (0.0038)	-0.0015* (0.0009)	-0.0229*** (0.0038)
TobinsQ	0.0047*** (0.0008)	0.0045*** (0.0011)	0.0041*** (0.0008)	0.0040*** (0.0011)	0.0047*** (0.0012)	-0.0003 (0.0015)	0.0043*** (0.0012)	0.0000 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0715*** (0.0122)	-0.0157 (0.0122)	-0.0651*** (0.0122)	-0.0133 (0.0122)	-0.0966*** (0.0146)	-0.0800*** (0.0181)	-0.0943*** (0.0146)	-0.0791*** (0.0182)
Capex	-0.1610*** (0.0158)	-0.3087*** (0.0254)	-0.1647*** (0.0158)	-0.3005*** (0.0251)	-0.1206*** (0.0176)	-0.2327*** (0.0307)	-0.1304*** (0.0179)	-0.2373*** (0.0309)
DivDummy	-0.0058*** (0.0013)	-0.0043* (0.0023)	-0.0054*** (0.0013)	-0.0038 (0.0023)	-0.0023 (0.0020)	-0.0049 (0.0039)	-0.0028 (0.0020)	-0.0051 (0.0039)
sCFO	0.0081*** (0.0031)	-0.0003 (0.0016)	0.0072*** (0.0026)	-0.0005 (0.0016)	0.0085* (0.0043)	0.0044* (0.0024)	0.0081** (0.0039)	0.0043* (0.0023)
SalesGrowth	-0.0189*** (0.0045)	-0.0297*** (0.0048)	-0.0176*** (0.0044)	-0.0287*** (0.0048)	-0.0006 (0.0047)	-0.0053 (0.0036)	-0.0004 (0.0047)	-0.0049 (0.0036)
RDSales	0.0089*** (0.0020)	-0.0018 (0.0015)	0.0090*** (0.0020)	-0.0016 (0.0015)	0.0112*** (0.0027)	0.0002 (0.0020)	0.0114*** (0.0027)	0.0003 (0.0021)
CashFlowAt	0.1415*** (0.0166)	0.1741*** (0.0180)	0.1368*** (0.0165)	0.1729*** (0.0180)	0.0989*** (0.0172)	0.1233*** (0.0220)	0.0926*** (0.0173)	0.1205*** (0.0221)
DailyVola	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)
Lagged_DV	0.8605*** (0.0079)	0.6188*** (0.0133)	0.8571*** (0.0080)	0.6204*** (0.0134)	0.7807*** (0.0118)	0.3351*** (0.0174)	0.7762*** (0.0120)	0.3365*** (0.0174)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	38,737	38,737	38,737	38,737	38,764	38,764	38,764	38,764
R ²	0.827	0.432	0.829	0.432	0.713	0.163	0.714	0.164
Adj. R ²	0.827	0.412	0.828	0.411	0.712	0.134	0.714	0.133

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. DWZ Eq.5 decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 3: Cash Holdings: Cash-Flow-Volatility Moderation

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio				CashRatio.Lead			
ClarityCEO_c	-0.0088*** (0.0034)	-0.0059 (0.0047)	-0.0071** (0.0033)	-0.0058 (0.0047)	-0.0039 (0.0040)	-0.0137** (0.0081)	-0.0026 (0.0041)	-0.0137** (0.0081)
UncResCEO_c	0.0021** (0.0011)	0.0017* (0.0010)	0.0022** (0.0011)	0.0017** (0.0010)	0.0007 (0.0014)	0.0009 (0.0013)	0.0005 (0.0014)	0.0007 (0.0013)
UncPreCEO_c	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0006 (0.0011)	0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0007 (0.0012)	-0.0009 (0.0017)	0.0000 (0.0016)	-0.0014 (0.0018)	-0.0002 (0.0016)
HighCFvol	-0.0005 (0.0012)	-0.0022 (0.0016)	-0.0028** (0.0013)	-0.0023 (0.0016)	0.0092*** (0.0016)	0.0028 (0.0022)	0.0075*** (0.0017)	0.0029 (0.0022)
UncResCEO_c.x.HighCFvol	0.0004 (0.0020)	0.0004 (0.0019)	-0.0000 (0.0020)	0.0002 (0.0019)	0.0039* (0.0027)	0.0025 (0.0024)	0.0040* (0.0027)	0.0027 (0.0024)
UncPreCEO_c.x.HighCFvol	0.0048** (0.0022)	0.0002 (0.0024)	0.0049** (0.0022)	0.0002 (0.0024)	0.0060** (0.0033)	0.0035 (0.0035)	0.0061** (0.0033)	0.0036 (0.0035)
Leverage	-0.0127*** (0.0034)	-0.0191** (0.0082)	-0.0130*** (0.0036)	-0.0189** (0.0082)	-0.0270*** (0.0096)	-0.0089 (0.0106)	-0.0267*** (0.0096)	-0.0083 (0.0106)
InAssets	0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0174*** (0.0026)	-0.0015*** (0.0006)	-0.0169*** (0.0026)	0.0015*** (0.0005)	-0.0179*** (0.0037)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	-0.0180*** (0.0037)
TobinsQ	0.0044*** (0.0008)	0.0037*** (0.0011)	0.0035*** (0.0008)	0.0034*** (0.0011)	0.0055*** (0.0012)	0.0005 (0.0016)	0.0049*** (0.0012)	0.0007 (0.0016)
ROA	-0.0641*** (0.0117)	-0.0148 (0.0123)	-0.0563*** (0.0116)	-0.0121 (0.0123)	-0.0985*** (0.0149)	-0.0733*** (0.0184)	-0.0964*** (0.0149)	-0.0726*** (0.0186)
Capex	-0.1692*** (0.0158)	-0.3164*** (0.0251)	-0.1779*** (0.0160)	-0.3085*** (0.0249)	-0.1159*** (0.0175)	-0.2361*** (0.0313)	-0.1275*** (0.0177)	-0.2400*** (0.0314)
DivDummy	-0.0057*** (0.0013)	-0.0051** (0.0023)	-0.0054*** (0.0013)	-0.0046** (0.0023)	-0.0013 (0.0019)	-0.0063 (0.0041)	-0.0017 (0.0020)	-0.0065 (0.0041)
sCFO	0.0087** (0.0043)	0.0004 (0.0017)	0.0078** (0.0037)	0.0003 (0.0017)	0.0084 (0.0055)	0.0043* (0.0026)	0.0083 (0.0053)	0.0043* (0.0026)
SalesGrowth	-0.0203*** (0.0050)	-0.0291*** (0.0057)	-0.0192*** (0.0049)	-0.0283*** (0.0057)	0.0003 (0.0042)	-0.0070* (0.0037)	0.0006 (0.0043)	-0.0066* (0.0037)
RDSales	0.0063*** (0.0022)	-0.0031** (0.0015)	0.0063*** (0.0022)	-0.0029** (0.0015)	0.0109*** (0.0029)	-0.0006 (0.0025)	0.0110*** (0.0029)	-0.0006 (0.0026)
CashFlowAt	0.1476*** (0.0170)	0.1713*** (0.0179)	0.1382*** (0.0171)	0.1698*** (0.0179)	0.1015*** (0.0181)	0.1107*** (0.0225)	0.0926*** (0.0183)	0.1082*** (0.0227)
DailyVola	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)
Lagged_DV	0.8664*** (0.0077)	0.6307*** (0.0133)	0.8619*** (0.0078)	0.6322*** (0.0133)	0.7796*** (0.0119)	0.3488*** (0.0182)	0.7752*** (0.0121)	0.3498*** (0.0182)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	40,795	40,795	40,795	40,795	39,207	39,207	39,207	39,207
R ²	0.825	0.447	0.826	0.447	0.708	0.171	0.709	0.171
Adj. R ²	0.824	0.429	0.826	0.428	0.707	0.143	0.708	0.142

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2018. Full panel coverage via Compustat Quarterly OCF Extended (1990-2002 backfill); Han-Qiu 16-trailing-quarter CFvol available from 1994-Q1 onwards in source data. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 4: Political Risk and Call Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	Industry FE		Firm FE	
	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO
PRisk	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)
UncQue	-0.0022 (0.0032)	0.0204*** (0.0045)	-0.0014 (0.0037)	0.0081*** (0.0029)
NegCall	-0.0025 (0.0051)	0.1874*** (0.0141)	-0.0036 (0.0073)	0.1477*** (0.0082)
lnAssets	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0296*** (0.0039)	-0.0054 (0.0058)	0.0048 (0.0078)
TobinsQ	-0.0005 (0.0009)	-0.0007 (0.0036)	-0.0008 (0.0022)	0.0001 (0.0023)
ROA	0.0291** (0.0145)	0.0477 (0.0318)	0.0540** (0.0264)	0.0346 (0.0230)
CashRatio	0.0019 (0.0077)	-0.0354 (0.0357)	0.0206 (0.0240)	0.0265 (0.0287)
DivDummy	-0.0031 (0.0021)	-0.0139 (0.0118)	-0.0108 (0.0074)	-0.0229** (0.0103)
FirmMat	0.0012 (0.0013)	0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0027 (0.0041)	0.0006 (0.0007)
EarnVol	0.0078 (0.0077)	-0.0072 (0.0157)	0.0056 (0.0117)	-0.0104 (0.0132)
UncPreCEO	-0.0051 (0.0034)		-0.0054 (0.0054)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes		
Firm FE			Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	44,497	65,760	44,497	65,760
R^2	0.003	0.043	0.003	0.023
Adj. R^2	0.002	0.043	-0.030	-0.004

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 5: Political Risk and Call Uncertainty (Two-Quarter Lag)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	Industry FE		Firm FE	
	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO
PRisk_lag2	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)
UncQue	0.0001 (0.0033)	0.0242 *** (0.0047)	0.0010 (0.0038)	0.0099 *** (0.0031)
NegCall	0.0020 (0.0052)	0.2019 *** (0.0145)	0.0019 (0.0074)	0.1609 *** (0.0084)
lnAssets	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0298 *** (0.0040)	-0.0035 (0.0062)	0.0047 (0.0078)
TobinsQ	-0.0005 (0.0010)	-0.0002 (0.0037)	-0.0011 (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0023)
ROA	0.0293 * (0.0152)	0.0518 (0.0331)	0.0598 ** (0.0272)	0.0464 * (0.0247)
CashRatio	0.0064 (0.0076)	-0.0400 (0.0368)	0.0170 (0.0242)	0.0233 (0.0292)
DivDummy	-0.0031 (0.0022)	-0.0142 (0.0121)	-0.0133 * (0.0076)	-0.0207 * (0.0106)
FirmMat	0.0013 (0.0013)	0.0021 (0.0015)	0.0025 (0.0041)	-0.0007 (0.0016)
EarnVol	0.0096 (0.0063)	-0.0078 (0.0159)	0.0089 (0.0100)	-0.0154 (0.0158)
UncPreCEO	-0.0001 (0.0035)		-0.0003 (0.0056)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes		
Firm FE			Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	43,037	63,022	43,037	63,022
R^2	0.000	0.035	0.000	0.015
Adj. R^2	-0.001	0.034	-0.033	-0.013

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 6: Product-Market Competition and Call Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	Industry FE		Firm FE	
	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO
z_log_TotalSimilarity	0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0304*** (0.0074)	0.0023 (0.0075)	0.0302*** (0.0093)
UncQue	0.0011 (0.0062)	0.0398*** (0.0100)	0.0039 (0.0087)	0.0084 (0.0073)
NegCall	0.0020 (0.0068)	0.2340*** (0.0201)	0.0046 (0.0120)	0.1698*** (0.0140)
lnAssets	-0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0335*** (0.0038)	-0.0101 (0.0071)	0.0013 (0.0081)
TobinsQ	0.0001 (0.0013)	-0.0007 (0.0037)	0.0009 (0.0025)	-0.0017 (0.0025)
ROA	0.0233 (0.0197)	0.0681** (0.0314)	0.0343 (0.0308)	0.0241 (0.0254)
CashRatio	0.0065 (0.0103)	-0.0803** (0.0360)	0.0055 (0.0287)	0.0022 (0.0306)
DivDummy	-0.0020 (0.0028)	-0.0060 (0.0117)	-0.0074 (0.0083)	-0.0166 (0.0106)
FirmMat	0.0018 (0.0019)	0.0014** (0.0007)	0.0083 (0.0056)	0.0003 (0.0004)
EarnVol	-0.0047 (0.0087)	-0.0210 (0.0152)	-0.0048 (0.0121)	-0.0114 (0.0146)
UncPreCEO	0.0111** (0.0044)		0.0230** (0.0093)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes		
Firm FE			Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	12,728	18,492	12,728	18,492
R^2	0.001	0.050	0.001	0.021
Adj. R^2	-0.002	0.048	-0.098	-0.068

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Unit of observation: firm-fiscal-year. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 7: US Policy Uncertainty and Call Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	Industry + Cal. Year FE		Firm + Cal. Year FE	
	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO
US_EPU_log	0.0124** (0.0075)	0.0211*** (0.0074)	0.0123* (0.0075)	0.0239*** (0.0076)
UncQue	0.0011 (0.0035)	0.0164*** (0.0032)	0.0024 (0.0040)	0.0095*** (0.0028)
NegCall	0.0006 (0.0056)	0.1247*** (0.0089)	0.0021 (0.0073)	0.1385*** (0.0079)
InAssets	0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0143*** (0.0020)	0.0013 (0.0067)	0.0038 (0.0063)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 (0.0011)	0.0007 (0.0019)	-0.0000 (0.0027)	0.0007 (0.0018)
ROA	0.0281* (0.0149)	0.0367** (0.0168)	0.0677** (0.0268)	0.0467** (0.0191)
CashRatio	0.0051 (0.0087)	-0.0079 (0.0187)	0.0345 (0.0256)	0.0305 (0.0231)
DivDummy	-0.0046*** (0.0009)	-0.0074 (0.0061)	-0.0142** (0.0072)	-0.0157* (0.0083)
FirmMat	0.0023* (0.0012)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0005 (0.0047)	-0.0011 (0.0012)
EarnVol	0.0268* (0.0157)	-0.0074 (0.0086)	0.0353** (0.0176)	-0.0083 (0.0119)
UncPreCEO	-0.0026 (0.0032)		-0.0011 (0.0045)	
Lagged_DV	0.0202*** (0.0054)	0.5176*** (0.0131)	0.0187*** (0.0056)	0.2626*** (0.0089)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes		
Firm FE			Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	39,063	60,503	39,063	60,503
R ²	0.001	0.292	0.001	0.084
Adj. R ²	-0.000	0.291	-0.035	0.057

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 8: Global Policy Uncertainty and Call Uncertainty

	(1) Industry + Cal. Year FE	(2) Industry + Cal. Year FE	(3) Firm + Cal. Year FE	(4) Firm + Cal. Year FE
	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO	UncResCEO	UncPreCEO
GEPU_log	0.0181** (0.0100)	0.0271*** (0.0107)	0.0187** (0.0101)	0.0309*** (0.0108)
UncQue	0.0011 (0.0035)	0.0164*** (0.0032)	0.0024 (0.0039)	0.0095*** (0.0028)
NegCall	0.0006 (0.0056)	0.1247*** (0.0089)	0.0020 (0.0072)	0.1385*** (0.0079)
lnAssets	0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0143*** (0.0020)	0.0012 (0.0067)	0.0037 (0.0063)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0019)	0.0000 (0.0027)	0.0007 (0.0018)
ROA	0.0280* (0.0149)	0.0367** (0.0168)	0.0673** (0.0267)	0.0462** (0.0191)
CashRatio	0.0051 (0.0087)	-0.0080 (0.0188)	0.0345 (0.0256)	0.0304 (0.0231)
DivDummy	-0.0047*** (0.0009)	-0.0074 (0.0061)	-0.0142** (0.0072)	-0.0156* (0.0083)
FirmMat	0.0023* (0.0012)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0047)	-0.0011 (0.0012)
EarnVol	0.0269* (0.0157)	-0.0074 (0.0086)	0.0354** (0.0176)	-0.0082 (0.0119)
UncPreCEO	-0.0026 (0.0032)		-0.0011 (0.0045)	
Lagged_DV	0.0202*** (0.0054)	0.5176*** (0.0131)	0.0187*** (0.0056)	0.2626*** (0.0089)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes		
Firm FE			Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	39,063	60,503	39,063	60,503
R ²	0.001	0.292	0.001	0.084
Adj. R ²	-0.000	0.291	-0.035	0.057

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 9: CEO Uncertainty and the Bid-Ask Spread

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTLevel_Spread						BGTLevel_Spread_lead1			
ClarityCEO	-0.0477 (0.2145)	1.0617 (0.4277)	0.2122 (0.2227)	1.1056 (0.4260)	0.1644 (0.2103)	1.0547 (0.4174)	-0.1886 (0.2370)	0.5998 (0.4004)	-0.0922 (0.2399)	0.6828 (0.4055)	-0.0431 (0.2206)	0.5722 (0.3729)
UncResCEO	-0.0594 (0.1068)	-0.0687 (0.1057)	-0.0882 (0.1023)	-0.1021 (0.1007)	-0.0757 (0.0994)	-0.0893 (0.0981)	0.0825 (0.1416)	0.0696 (0.1437)	0.0742 (0.1407)	0.0545 (0.1426)	0.0984 (0.1339)	0.0751 (0.1357)
UncPreCEO	0.1664** (0.0946)	0.3496*** (0.1253)	0.0814 (0.0956)	0.2945*** (0.1229)	0.0108 (0.0919)	0.1644* (0.1184)	-0.0817 (0.0926)	-0.0288 (0.1229)	-0.1072 (0.0926)	-0.0360 (0.1233)	0.0170 (0.0872)	0.1124 (0.1186)
lnAssets	-0.8039*** (0.0490)	-1.9098*** (0.2000)	-0.6339*** (0.0472)	-1.6825*** (0.2156)	-0.6352*** (0.0473)	-1.8277*** (0.2158)	-0.8218*** (0.0513)	-1.5191*** (0.1951)	-0.7857*** (0.0505)	-1.7292*** (0.2130)	-0.6568*** (0.0474)	-1.4181*** (0.2017)
TobinsQ	-0.2861*** (0.0457)	-0.4785*** (0.0900)	-0.2633*** (0.0470)	-0.5518*** (0.0963)	-0.2654*** (0.0451)	-0.5883*** (0.0956)	-0.2305*** (0.0467)	-0.3215*** (0.0850)	-0.2285*** (0.0478)	-0.4803*** (0.1002)	-0.2035*** (0.0433)	-0.4289*** (0.0935)
ROA	-9.4469*** (1.0201)	-11.6430*** (1.3867)	-5.7059*** (0.9822)	-7.6844*** (1.2654)	-5.7511*** (0.9633)	-7.8517*** (1.2490)	-9.9256*** (1.0798)	-12.8443*** (1.2992)	-8.8744*** (1.0722)	-11.9197*** (1.2732)	-7.6375*** (0.9869)	-10.5867*** (1.1921)
Leverage	0.3875* (0.2088)	1.8330*** (0.5143)	-0.1126 (0.2434)	0.6850 (0.5013)	-0.0542 (0.2264)	0.8026 (0.4954)	0.2924 (0.2224)	0.5282 (0.5516)	0.1338 (0.2248)	0.2221 (0.5596)	0.0592 (0.2111)	0.1928 (0.5258)
Capex	-0.8001 (1.1109)	0.9540 (2.9126)	-2.3622** (1.1044)	-1.5271 (2.8061)	-2.0790* (1.0845)	-1.2897 (2.7998)	-1.6463* (0.9620)	-3.2121 (2.2020)	-2.1561** (0.9823)	-4.3379* (2.2446)	-1.4770 (0.9011)	-2.4356 (2.1565)
DivDummy	0.1043 (0.0893)	0.1429 (0.2020)	0.3329*** (0.0896)	0.2549 (0.1888)	0.3156*** (0.0855)	0.2723 (0.1867)	0.0240 (0.0887)	0.1007 (0.2095)	0.1012 (0.0889)	0.1454 (0.2074)	0.1145 (0.0825)	0.1739 (0.1975)
sCFO	0.6700** (0.3405)	0.8405** (0.3472)	0.4045 (0.4604)	0.6825* (0.3789)	0.4084 (0.4126)	0.6882** (0.3375)	0.0871 (0.1759)	0.3644* (0.1877)	0.0040 (0.2174)	0.3165 (0.2055)	-0.0840 (0.1937)	0.2479 (0.1738)
Lagged_DV	0.7547*** (0.0150)	0.6569*** (0.0186)	0.7140*** (0.0167)	0.6180*** (0.0199)	0.7310*** (0.0168)	0.6318*** (0.0208)	0.7540*** (0.0156)	0.6361*** (0.0185)	0.7360*** (0.0173)	0.6135*** (0.0205)	0.7676*** (0.0162)	0.6518*** (0.0197)
StockPrice			-0.0011 (0.0014)	-0.0033 (0.0024)	0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0019 (0.0024)			-0.0001 (0.0013)	0.0101*** (0.0024)	-0.0016 (0.0012)	0.0047** (0.0022)
Turnover			-24.1012*** (1.7508)	-23.8647*** (2.2119)	-20.7840*** (1.7290)	-20.3411*** (2.1791)			-7.9396*** (1.5411)	-5.5050*** (2.0904)	-7.1303*** (1.4699)	-4.7073** (1.9633)
DailyVola			0.1229*** (0.0072)	0.1393*** (0.0081)	0.1075*** (0.0082)	0.1257*** (0.0099)			0.0404*** (0.0062)	0.0520*** (0.0068)	0.0396*** (0.0069)	0.0441*** (0.0081)
AbsSurpDec			-0.0919*** (0.0265)	-0.0241 (0.0300)	-0.0756*** (0.0253)	-0.0093 (0.0286)			-0.0050 (0.0278)	0.0119 (0.0304)	-0.0174 (0.0261)	-0.0012 (0.0285)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	42,625	42,625	42,625	42,625	42,625	42,625	43,049	43,049	43,049	43,049	43,049	43,049
R ²	0.703	0.517	0.721	0.551	0.730	0.548	0.700	0.499	0.702	0.504	0.723	0.523
Adj. R ²	0.703	0.501	0.721	0.535	0.730	0.532	0.700	0.482	0.702	0.487	0.723	0.506

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). DWZ Full decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). Spread_{25D} values rescaled by 10^4 (basis points) for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw fraction units.

Table 10: CEO Uncertainty and SEC Comment-Letter Receipt

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	CCCL					
ClarityCEO	0.0059 (0.0015)	0.0039 (0.0030)	0.0062 (0.0015)	0.0040 (0.0030)	0.0058 (0.0015)	0.0040 (0.0030)
UncResCEO	-0.0003 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0009)
UncPreCEO	0.0008 (0.0008)	0.0014* (0.0009)	0.0016** (0.0007)	0.0014* (0.0009)	0.0007 (0.0008)	0.0013* (0.0009)
lnAssets	-0.0006** (0.0002)	0.0018* (0.0011)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0017 (0.0010)	-0.0006** (0.0003)	0.0019* (0.0011)
TobinsQ	-0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0004)
ROA	0.0006 (0.0034)	0.0012 (0.0052)	-0.0014 (0.0052)	-0.0006 (0.0062)	-0.0006 (0.0051)	-0.0004 (0.0062)
Leverage	-0.0008 (0.0015)	-0.0019 (0.0034)	-0.0009 (0.0015)	-0.0011 (0.0035)	-0.0009 (0.0015)	-0.0012 (0.0035)
Capex	-0.0029 (0.0063)	0.0106 (0.0104)	0.0004 (0.0064)	0.0111 (0.0104)	-0.0033 (0.0066)	0.0107 (0.0103)
CashRatio	-0.0014 (0.0027)	-0.0075* (0.0044)	0.0009 (0.0026)	-0.0080* (0.0044)	-0.0014 (0.0028)	-0.0082* (0.0044)
DivDummy	-0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0003 (0.0015)	-0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0002 (0.0015)	-0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0002 (0.0015)
sCFO	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0020 (0.0024)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0019 (0.0024)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0019 (0.0024)
Lagged_DV	-0.0079*** (0.0008)	-0.0409*** (0.0027)	-0.0077*** (0.0007)	-0.0410*** (0.0027)	-0.0074*** (0.0008)	-0.0405*** (0.0028)
SalesGrowth			-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0013 (0.0011)	-0.0001 (0.0008)	-0.0011 (0.0011)
RDSales			-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)
CashFlowAt			0.0025 (0.0050)	0.0043 (0.0064)	0.0009 (0.0050)	0.0037 (0.0064)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes
N	44,113	44,113	44,096	44,096	44,096	44,096
R ²	0.001	0.002	0.000	0.002	0.001	0.002
Adj. R ²	-0.000	-0.032	-0.001	-0.032	-0.001	-0.033

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). DWZ Full decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 11: Campello Brexit Replication Suite

	CASH (eq. 14)		CASH (PSM)		UncRes		UncRes (PSM)		UncRes _{≥m}		UncRes _{≥m} (PSM)		Campello T.8	
	(1) β^{UK} tercile	(2) textual Item 1+7	(3) β^{UK} tercile	(4) textual Item 1+7	(5) β^{UK} tercile	(6) textual Item 1+7	(7) β^{UK} tercile	(8) textual Item 1+7	(9) β^{UK} tercile	(10) textual Item 1+7	(11) β^{UK} tercile	(12) textual Item 1+7	(13) col. 1	(14) col. 2
POST_x.HIGH	0.0179 (0.0381)	0.0756** (0.0328)	0.0621* (0.0398)	0.0317 (0.0403)	0.0245 (0.0272)	-0.0247 (0.0459)	0.0018 (0.0690)	-0.0256 (0.0593)	0.0127 (0.0448)	-0.1128 (0.0960)	0.0270 (0.0991)	-0.1316 (0.1116)	0.2310*** (0.0470)	0.3570*** (0.0620)
brexit_stock_return	0.0447** (0.0227)	0.0314 (0.0468)	-0.0215 (0.0552)	-0.0042 (0.0401)	0.0334 (0.0320)	0.0199 (0.0231)	-0.0016 (0.0542)	-0.0553 (0.0463)	0.0238 (0.0537)	-0.0341 (0.0440)	-0.0404 (0.0757)	-0.0669 (0.0992)	n.r.	n.r.
brexit_tobins_q	0.0673*** (0.0207)	0.0590* (0.0328)	0.1356** (0.0546)	0.0554** (0.0272)	0.0094 (0.0085)	0.0067 (0.0083)	0.0163 (0.0104)	0.0153 (0.0140)	0.0124 (0.0165)	0.0137 (0.0165)	0.0240 (0.0237)	0.0359 (0.0257)	n.r.	n.r.
brexit_cash_flow	0.3047 (0.4697)	-1.3628** (0.5311)	0.5083 (1.1460)	-0.2889 (0.3260)	0.3294 (0.3531)	0.4344 (0.4163)	0.0573 (0.4489)	0.1215 (0.4785)	0.3798 (0.3736)	0.4430 (0.6837)	0.0640 (0.4544)	-0.3386 (0.9891)	n.r.	n.r.
brexit_sales_growth	-0.0235 (0.0207)	-0.0530* (0.0273)	-0.0176 (nan)	-0.0461** (0.0202)	-0.0129 (0.0238)	-0.0119 (0.0151)	0.0043 (0.0393)	-0.0086 (0.0258)	-0.0504 (0.0309)	-0.0379* (0.0219)	-0.0447 (0.0485)	-0.0465 (0.0582)	n.r.	n.r.
log_assets	-0.0489 (0.0452)	-0.1627*** (0.0531)	0.0868 (0.1180)	-0.1008** (0.0456)	-0.0230 (0.0265)	-0.0448* (0.0246)	-0.0597 (0.0420)	-0.0408 (0.0302)	-0.0337 (0.0477)	-0.0795* (0.0427)	-0.1036 (0.0760)	-0.0698 (0.0622)	n.r.	n.r.
cons_fwd	-0.0125 (0.0246)	0.0239 (0.0246)	-0.0902 (0.0841)	0.0038 (0.0160)	-0.0025 (0.0260)	-0.0148 (0.0189)	0.0622** (0.0295)	0.0331 (0.0314)	0.0163 (0.0400)	-0.0117 (0.0309)	0.0998 (0.0678)	0.0309 (0.0604)	n.r.	n.r.
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Ind.(FIC100)×qtr FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
PSM (3-NN, w/ repl.)	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Binary DV 1 [UncRes _{≥med}]	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
N	17,089	21,354	14,633	21,292	6,658	9,415	5,024	9,407	6,658	9,415	5,024	9,407	17,170	24,195
Firms	819	979	716	966	371	526	292	520	371	526	292	520	n.r.	n.r.
R ²	0.0253 [‡]	0.0387 [‡]	0.0577 [‡]	0.0415 [‡]	0.0006 [‡]	-0.0010 [‡]	-0.0019 [‡]	0.0002 [‡]	0.0006 [‡]	-0.0058 [‡]	-0.0007 [‡]	-0.0013 [‡]	0.21 [†]	0.24 [†]

Notes: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$; CASH columns (1)–(4) one-tailed, UncResCEO columns (5)–(12) two-tailed; significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (parentheses) double-clustered firm $\times$ calendar-quarter. **UncRes** = UncResCEO (DWZ Eq.4 CEO Q&A residual, firm-quarter mean); **UncRes_{≥m}** = **1**[UncResCEO $\geq$ pooled per-arm median] (LPM). **(PSM)** columns re-estimate eq-(14) weighted on the 3-NN-with-replacement propensity-matched sub-panel (our extension; Campello match investment/R&D/divestitures, not cash or uncertainty). [‡]within- R^2 ; [†]Campello reported R^2 .

Table 12: Campello Replication: Summary Statistics

Variable	Rebuild					Campello (2022) Table 1 Panel A				
	mean	SD	med	IQR	N	mean	SD	med	IQR	N
CASH_T1	+0.237	+0.299	+0.127	+0.279	75,934	+0.220	+0.250	+0.120	+0.270	78,044
SIZE	+6.235	+2.038	+6.197	+3.015	78,430	+6.190	+2.080	+6.150	+3.080	78,062
STOCK_RETURNS	+0.029	+0.232	+0.020	+0.250	64,423	+0.030	+0.240	+0.020	+0.250	67,226
TOBIN_Q	+2.179	+1.677	+1.608	+1.284	72,602	+2.110	+1.590	+1.570	+1.260	73,353
CASH_FLOW	+0.010	+0.072	+0.026	+0.039	75,592	+0.010	+0.060	+0.030	+0.040	75,287
SALES_GROWTH	+0.179	+0.685	+0.064	+0.243	74,607	+0.160	+0.620	+0.060	+0.230	71,637
CONSENSUS_EPS	-0.048	+1.080	+0.045	+0.431	47,626	+0.070	+3.510	+0.090	+2.050	42,031
Firms — market (β^{UK} -tercile, treated)	—	—	—	—	478	—	—	—	—	449
Firms — market (β^{UK} -tercile, control)	—	—	—	—	478	—	—	—	—	360
Firms — textual (§ 1+7, >5 entries, treated)	—	—	—	—	1,458	—	—	—	—	807
Firms — textual (§ 1+7, zero entries, control)	—	—	—	—	465	—	—	—	—	433
<i>PSM matched sample — CASH ($cheq_t/atq_{t-1}$, T1) mean and firm count (N)</i>										
market PSM matched (treated)	+0.215	—	—	—	380	+0.175	—	—	—	n.r.
market PSM matched (control)	+0.231	—	—	—	338	+0.164	—	—	—	n.r.
textual PSM matched (treated)	+0.228	—	—	—	793	+0.232	—	—	—	n.r.
textual PSM matched (control)	+0.164	—	—	—	176	+0.194	—	—	—	n.r.

Table 13: Boasiako-Keefe Disclosure-Law Replication

	Boasiako-Keefe (2020) Table 2 Col (1) (1)	This paper (F1D rebuild) CASH UncResCEO (2) (3)	
Disclosure_Law	0.0076** (0.0031)	0.0159** (0.0084)	0.0082 (0.0104)
firm_size	-0.0110*** (0.0022)	-0.0130*** (0.0023)	-0.0015 (0.0010)
firm_age	-0.0213*** (0.0044)	-0.0652*** (0.0093)	0.0081* (0.0049)
book_leverage	-0.1400*** (0.0206)	-0.2033*** (0.0116)	-0.0135* (0.0070)
market_to_book	0.0080*** (0.0015)	0.0158*** (0.0013)	0.0010 (0.0011)
cash_flow	-0.0049*** (0.0018)	0.1473*** (0.0203)	0.0130 (0.0188)
capital_expenditure	-0.0709** (0.0280)	0.6336*** (0.1030)	-0.0003 (0.0254)
acquisition_expenditure	-0.0052 (0.0048)	-0.0507 (0.0344)	-0.0168 (0.0142)
rd_expenditure	0.1909*** (0.0281)	1.1121*** (0.0437)	-0.0382 (0.0314)
nwc	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0390*** (0.0110)	-0.0018 (0.0029)
dividend_paying	-0.0072** (0.0028)	-0.0087 (0.0064)	-0.0044 (0.0035)
industry_cf_vol	0.0273*** (0.0068)	0.2635*** (0.0765)	-0.0006 (0.0005)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
State FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	56,646	48,336	9,709
R ²	0.494	0.294	0.003

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (headline one-tailed $\beta > 0$; controls two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at the state level.

Table 14: Disclosure-Law Sample: Summary Statistics

	Boasiako-Keefe (2020)					This paper				
	Mean	SD	p25	p50	p75	Mean	SD	p25	p50	p75
cash_w	0.2008	0.2231	0.0285	0.1044	0.2913	0.3195	0.5091	0.0460	0.1507	0.3841
firm_size_w	5.6136	2.0593	4.0819	5.5717	7.0455	5.4308	2.4517	3.7921	5.5495	7.1420
firm_age_w	7.3003	0.8889	2.0179	5.0435	11.0918	2.3542	1.1065	1.7918	2.5649	3.1355
book_leverage_w	0.2362	0.3177	0.0229	0.1863	0.3528	0.2728	0.4780	0.0033	0.1577	0.3447
market_to_book_w	2.1592	2.9919	1.1104	1.5113	2.3119	2.9332	4.7384	1.2013	1.6676	2.6915
cash_flow_w	-0.3758	4.8386	-0.0150	0.0684	0.1210	-0.1502	0.7634	-0.0616	0.0544	0.1012
capital_expenditure_w	0.0657	0.1248	0.0174	0.0364	0.0729	0.0565	0.0857	0.0126	0.0289	0.0616
acquisition_expenditure_w	0.0451	0.1672	0.0000	0.0000	0.0144	0.0318	0.0979	0.0000	0.0000	0.0077
rd_expenditure_w	0.0709	0.1895	0.0000	0.0021	0.0738	0.0927	0.2082	0.0000	0.0042	0.0913
nwc_w	-0.0584	1.0372	-0.0589	0.0636	0.2157	-0.1188	0.9902	-0.0794	0.0182	0.1417
dividend_paying_w	0.2767	—	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	0.2697	—	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
industry_cf_vol_w	0.3440	0.5270	0.0825	0.1403	0.2499	0.0737	0.0576	0.0383	0.0577	0.0936
Observations	56,646					48,336				

Empire-Building Run-Up Test — Regression Specification

All four regressions share one estimating equation; they differ only in the outcome Y and in which firms are eligible to be treated. Estimator: two-way fixed-effects OLS (PanelOLS), firm-clustered standard errors.

$$Y_{i,t} = \beta \text{PreAnnounceQtr}_{i,t} + \gamma' \mathbf{X}_{i,t} + \alpha_i + \tau_t + \varepsilon_{i,t}$$

where i indexes the firm (its earnings call) and t the calendar year-quarter. β is the coefficient of interest: one-tailed test ($H_1 : \beta > 0$) for PreAnnounceQtr, two-tailed for the controls.

Reg.	Outcome Y	Treated set (firms eligible for PreAnnounceQtr = 1)
(1)	CashRatio	Cash acquirers ($\geq 50\%$ cash)
(2)	UncResCEO	Cash acquirers ($\geq 50\%$ cash)
(3)	CashRatio	Stock acquirers ($\geq 50\%$ stock) — placebo
(4)	UncResCEO	Stock acquirers ($\geq 50\%$ stock) — placebo

Symbol	Definition	Role
<i>Outcomes</i>		
CashRatio	cheq/atq (Compustat)	cash-holdings level (first stage)
UncResCEO	residual $\hat{\varepsilon}_{ic}$ from $\text{UncAnsCEO}_{ic} = \alpha + \text{CEO-FE}_i + \mathbf{X}_{ic}\gamma + \varepsilon_{ic}$ (DWZ Eqn. 4)	call-level CEO Q&A uncertainty, net of the CEO's permanent style
<i>Treatment</i>		
PreAnnounceQtr _{i,t}	= 1 in the single quarter immediately before firm i 's first qualifying deal ($e = -1$); post-announcement quarters ($e \geq 0$) are dropped; never-acquirers are always 0	pre-event (anticipation) indicator
<i>Controls $\mathbf{X}$ (H1 cash set, lagged DV removed; Compustat quarterly)</i>		
Leverage	(dlcq + dlttq)/atq	interest-bearing debt / assets
lnAssets	ln(atq)	firm size
TobinsQ	(atq + cshoq · prccq – ceqq)/atq	market-to-book / growth opportunities
ROA	iby/assets	profitability
Capex	capxy/atq	investment intensity
DivDummy	≠[dvy > 0]	dividend payer
sCFO	5-yr rolling SD of oancfy/atq _{$t-1$}	cash-flow volatility
<i>Fixed effects / errors</i>		
α_i	firm fixed effect (EntityEffects)	removes each firm's permanent level (within-firm identification)
τ_t	calendar year-quarter fixed effect (TimeEffects)	removes economy-wide shocks each quarter
$\varepsilon_{i,t}$	idiosyncratic error, clustered by firm	

Reading the columns. (1)–(2) are the cash-acquirer arm: does cash, and then CEO uncertainty, rise in the quarter before a cash-financed deal? (3)–(4) are the stock-acquirer placebo: stock buyers face the same pending-deal disclosure gag but hold no cash war-chest, so (4) flat while (2) positive $\Rightarrow$ the uncertainty rise is cash-specific, not mere deal secrecy.

Table 15: Empire-Building Run-Up Test

	Cash acquirers				Stock acquirers (placebo)			
	(1) CashRatio	(2) UncResCEO	(3) CashScrutiny	(4) HighCashScrutiny	(5) CashRatio	(6) UncResCEO	(7) CashScrutiny	(8) HighCashScrutiny
PreAnnounceQtr	0.0071 *** (0.0030)	0.0461 *** (0.0172)	0.0854 (0.0749)	0.0408 ** (0.0194)	-0.0015 (0.0062)	-0.0429 (0.0307)	-0.3222 (0.2024)	-0.0303 (0.0313)
Leverage	-0.0515 *** (0.0161)	-0.0338 (0.0217)	-0.1521 (0.1470)	-0.0179 (0.0308)	-0.0743 *** (0.0144)	-0.0292 (0.0196)	-0.1056 (0.1358)	-0.0428 (0.0262)
LnAssets	-0.0339 *** (0.0049)	-0.0037 (0.0082)	-0.0391 (0.0482)	0.0190 ** (0.0096)	-0.0311 *** (0.0037)	-0.0043 (0.0063)	-0.0733 ** (0.0369)	0.0077 (0.0078)
TobinsQ	0.0099 *** (0.0024)	-0.0031 (0.0030)	-0.0208 (0.0144)	0.0006 (0.0027)	0.0102 *** (0.0016)	-0.0017 (0.0025)	-0.0113 (0.0123)	0.0030 (0.0024)
ROA	0.0217 (0.0142)	0.0499 (0.0321)	-0.5659 ** (0.2254)	-0.1006 ** (0.0405)	0.0245 * (0.0138)	0.0530 * (0.0296)	-0.5350 *** (0.1982)	-0.0869 ** (0.0366)
Capex	-0.1571 *** (0.0416)	0.0842 (0.0986)	-1.2215 *** (0.3534)	-0.3646 *** (0.0880)	-0.1764 *** (0.0393)	0.1256 (0.1006)	-1.4479 *** (0.3000)	-0.4470 *** (0.0793)
DivDummy	0.0002 (0.0038)	-0.0030 (0.0106)	-0.0561 (0.0537)	-0.0111 (0.0107)	-0.0022 (0.0035)	-0.0137 * (0.0080)	-0.0564 (0.0384)	-0.0146 * (0.0087)
sCFO	0.0034 * (0.0017)	0.0052 (0.0085)	0.1180 *** (0.0140)	0.0235 *** (0.0028)	0.0035 (0.0021)	-0.0009 (0.0110)	0.0906 *** (0.0337)	0.0169 *** (0.0057)
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cal. Year-Quarter FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firms	2,245	1,248	1,237	1,237	2,290	1,338	1,325	1,325
N (firm-quarters)	73,642	27,622	26,216	26,216	92,116	39,377	37,065	37,065
R ²	0.054	0.001	0.002	0.002	0.058	0.001	0.002	0.002

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for the treatment coefficient, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. CashScrutiny (cols 3, 7) and HighCashScrutiny (cols 4, 8) are estimated on the UncResCEO call universe. HighCashScrutiny is an LPM on $\mathbf{1}[\text{CashScrutiny} > \text{median}]$; the median is 0 (89% of calls raise no cash turns), so it flags any cash scrutiny ($\approx 11\%$ of calls).

Table 16: Analyst Cash-Scrutiny Validity (Link 1)

	DV: CashScrutiny (% of analyst Q&A turns on cash/liquidity)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
CashRatio	0.7530 *** (0.0949)	0.8519 *** (0.0967)		
HighCash			0.1754 *** (0.0237)	0.1921 *** (0.0236)
Leverage	—	0.2180 ** (0.0978)	—	0.2030 ** (0.0987)
lnAssets	—	-0.0562 *** (0.0213)	—	-0.0744 *** (0.0212)
TobinsQ	—	-0.0272 *** (0.0089)	—	-0.0218 ** (0.0085)
ROA	—	-0.5012 *** (0.1339)	—	-0.5002 *** (0.1335)
Capex	—	-1.2348 *** (0.2890)	—	-1.3259 *** (0.2900)
DivDummy	—	-0.0674 ** (0.0331)	—	-0.0678 ** (0.0331)
sCFO	—	0.0244 (0.0274)	—	0.0291 (0.0277)
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cal. Year-Quarter FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	Yes	No	Yes
Firms	1,868	1,853	1,868	1,853
N (calls)	75,087	72,670	75,087	72,670
R ²	0.002	0.005	0.001	0.004

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for the cash coefficient, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level.

Cash-Scrutiny Measure: Variable Construction (Link 1)

Variable definitions.

- **CashScrutiny** $_{i,t}$ — share (%) of call i 's analyst Q&A turns whose text contains at least one *cash level* or *liquidity* term (listed below); a turn-level binary averaged over the call's analyst Q&A turns.
- **CashRatio** $_{i,t}$ = cheq/atq (cash & equivalents ÷ total assets).
- **High Cash** $_{i,t}$ = $\mathbf{1}[\text{CashRatio}_{i,t} \geq \text{top tercile}]$.
- **Controls** $X_{i,t}$: Leverage, ln(Assets), Tobin's Q, ROA, Capex, Dividend Payer, Cash Flow (sCFO).

Specification. Two-way fixed-effects OLS estimated at the call level:

$$\text{CashScrutiny}_{i,t} = \beta \text{Cash}_{i,t} + \gamma' X_{i,t} + \alpha_i + \delta_{q(t)} + \varepsilon_{i,t},$$

where $\text{Cash}_{i,t}$ = CashRatio (cols 1–2) or High Cash (cols 3–4); α_i = firm fixed effects, $\delta_{q(t)}$ = calendar year-quarter fixed effects; standard errors clustered by firm. The cash coefficient β is the external-validity test. **Search terms.** An analyst Q&A turn is flagged if, after the *excluded* phrases are blanked out, its lower-cased text contains any phrase below, matched on a word boundary (case-insensitive). Every literal spelling actually searched is listed: where a phrase has a singular/plural or hyphenated/closed variant (e.g. 'noncash' and 'non-cash'), both forms appear. Disposition/payout terms (dividends, buybacks) are deliberately *not* used here: they load on firm size and maturity and would correlate with CashRatio spuriously rather than through cash attention.

- **Cash level** (22 forms) — *why*: they name the firm's cash stockpile or balance itself, the direct object of attention to how much cash the firm holds.
'cash holding', 'cash holdings', 'cash balance', 'cash balances', 'cash position', 'cash on hand', 'cash on the balance sheet', 'cash reserve', 'cash reserves', 'cash and cash equivalents', 'cash and equivalents', 'cash and shortterm investments', 'cash and short-term investments', 'net cash', 'cash pile', 'cash hoard', 'cash stockpile', 'war chest', 'dry powder', 'excess cash', 'idle cash', 'surplus cash'
- **Liquidity** (5 forms) — *why*: standard analyst synonyms for the same liquid-asset buffer.
'liquidity', 'liquid assets', 'shortterm investments', 'short-term investments', 'marketable securities'
- **Excluded** (17 forms) — *why*: they contain “cash” but denote cash *flow*, earnings, an accounting basis, or an idiom rather than the cash holdings, so they are blanked out before matching to prevent false positives.
'free cash flow', 'operating cash flow', 'cash flow statement', 'cash flow', 'cash flows', 'cash conversion cycle', 'cash conversion', 'cash basis', 'cash cow', 'cash compensation', 'noncash', 'non-cash', 'cash register', 'cash crop', 'cash taxes', 'cash earnings', 'cash in on'

Table 17: Analyst Cash-Scrutiny Channel (Link 2)

	UncResCEO (DWZ residual)	UncAnsCEO (raw Q&A)
<i>Panel A. OLS — DV in continuous level</i>		
CashScrutiny	-0.0000 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0013)
<i>N</i> (calls)	41,512	41,512
Within R^2	0.000	0.000
<i>Panel B. Logit — DV = $\mathbf{1}[measure \geq median]$</i>		
CashScrutiny (log-odds)	-0.0003 (0.0074)	0.0080 (0.0085)
<i>N</i> (calls)	41,512	41,512
Pseudo R^2	0.002	0.019
Firm FE (A) / Industry FE (B)	Yes	Yes
Cal. Year-Quarter FE	Yes	Yes

Notes: DV is CEO Q&A uncertainty as the DWZ residual (UncResCEO, firm/linguistic component removed) or the raw measure (UncAnsCEO, pooled-1% winsorized). CashScrutiny = the share (%) of a call's Q&A turns devoted to cash topics (validated in the Link 1 table). Panel A is OLS on the continuous DV; Panel B is a logit on $\mathbf{1}[DV \geq \text{sample median}]$. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed); significant coefficients in **bold**; SE (parentheses) clustered at firm level. Coarser scrutiny measures (any-turn, raw count, log count) give the same null.

Table 18: Cash-Scrutiny Reason-Gating Test

	UncResCEO	
	(1)	(2)
CashScrutiny	0.0000 (0.0018)	0.0001 (0.0018)
PreAnnounceQtr	0.0413 *** (0.0177)	0.0439 ** (0.0189)
CashScrutiny $\times$ PreAnnounceQtr		-0.0056 (0.0111)
Controls	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes
Cal. Year-Quarter FE	Yes	Yes
N (firm-quarters)	26,216	26,216
Firms	1,237	1,237
R^2	0.001	0.001

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed, $\beta > 0$, for the directional terms); significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Estimated on cash-acquirer firms ($\geq 50\%$ -cash acquisitions; SDC, US public, 2002–2018) over their pre-announcement and earlier quarters (post-announcement quarters dropped); PreAnnounceQtr = 1[the single quarter before announcement]. Sample restricted to calls with both CashScrutiny and UncResCEO (the matched universe). CashScrutiny = % of a call's analyst Q&A turns on cash/liquidity. The reason (PreAnnounceQtr) raises CEO residual uncertainty; analyst cash-scrutiny does not, and the interaction is insignificant.

Table 19: Pre-Acquisition Uncertainty vs. Cash on the Matched Universe (disclosure-window event study)

	(1) UncResCEO	(2) CashRatio
PRE2 ($t-2$, pre-trend)	0.0105 (0.0174)	0.0065* (0.0041)
PRE1 ($t-1$, pre-announce)	0.0486*** (0.0174)	0.0108*** (0.0046)
GAP (announced, pre-close)	0.0058 (0.0181)	0.0120** (0.0056)
POST (completed)	-0.0195 (0.0127)	-0.0197 (0.0052)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	0.0428* (0.0221)	-0.0013 (0.0049)
Drop: PRE1 – POST	0.0681*** (0.0187)	0.0305*** (0.0043)
Firm FE / Year-Qtr FE / Controls	Yes	Yes
N (firm-quarters)	29,535	29,535
Firms	1,326	1,326

Notes: Two-way FE OLS (firm + calendar year-quarter), firm-clustered SE, on the *identical* 29,535-observation sample where both UncResCEO and CashRatio are present (the UncResCEO call universe). Event bins around the firm's first $\geq 50\%$ -cash acquisition: PRE2/PRE1 = two / one quarter pre-announcement; GAP = announced but not yet completed; POST = completed. Baseline = $e \leq -3$ plus never-acquirers. Bin coefficients: * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$ one-tailed; Drop rows (Wald on the bin difference): stars two-tailed. Standard errors in parentheses throughout. Pre-completion bin counts (PRE2/PRE1/GAP/POST): 389/396/378/1,535. UncResCEO peaks at PRE1 and collapses at GAP (announcement); CashRatio stays elevated through GAP and falls only at POST (completion). The uncertainty tracks the disclosure state, not the cash balance. Robustness: +8-quarter post-window in the summary JSON.

Table 20: Pre-Acquisition UncResCEO Event Study: Cash vs. Stock Acquirers (placebo)

	DV: UncResCEO	
	(1) Cash acquirers	(2) Stock acquirers
PRE2 ($t-2$, pre-trend)	0.0105 (0.0174)	-0.0056 (0.0368)
PRE1 ($t-1$, pre-announce)	0.0486*** (0.0174)	-0.0404 (0.0299)
GAP (announced, pre-close)	0.0058 (0.0181)	0.0353 (0.0318)
POST (completed)	-0.0195 (0.0127)	-0.0048 (0.0246)
Drop: PRE1 – GAP	0.0428* (0.0221)	-0.0756* (0.0405)
Drop: PRE1 – POST	0.0681*** (0.0187)	-0.0355 (0.0358)
Firm FE / Year-Qtr FE / Controls	Yes	Yes
N (firm-quarters)	29,535	39,819
Firms	1,326	1,363

Notes: Two-way FE OLS (firm + calendar year-quarter), firm-clustered SE; DV = UncResCEO. Event bins around the firm's first $\geq 50\%$ -cash (col 1) or $\geq 50\%$ -stock (col 2) acquisition: PRE2/PRE1 = two / one quarter pre-announcement; GAP = announced, not yet completed; POST = completed. Baseline = $e \leq -3$ plus never-acquirers. The **stock arm is the placebo**: stock-financed acquirers carry the same pending-deal disclosure gag but no cash war-chest, so a flat stock pattern means the cash-arm run-up and collapse are cash-specific. * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$; bins one-tailed ($\beta > 0$), Drop rows two-tailed. Standard errors in parentheses. (Per-DV samples differ here; the matched-universe table re-estimates both DVs on one sample. +8-quarter window in the summary JSON.)

Table 21: Formal Cash-Specificity of the Pre-Announcement Uncertainty Run-Up (cash vs. stock acquirers, pooled)

	(1) UncResCEO	(2) CashRatio
Pre-announce qtr, Cash acquirer	0.0459*** (0.0185)	0.0104*** (0.0043)
Pre-announce qtr, Stock acquirer	-0.0524 (0.0436)	0.0182* (0.0122)
Cash – Stock (formal test)	0.0983** (0.0476)	-0.0078 (0.0131)
Firm FE / Year-Qtr FE / Controls	Yes	Yes
N (firm-quarters)	25,600	25,600
Firms	1,191	1,191

Notes: Two-way FE OLS (firm + calendar year-quarter), firm-clustered SE, with both columns estimated on the *identical* $\text{UncResCEO} \cap \text{CashRatio}$ sample. Both pre-announce dummies enter the SAME model; the omitted baseline is the firm's pre-deal and never-acquirer quarters. **Pre-announce qtr** = the single quarter before the firm's first $\geq 50\%$ -cash (resp. stock) acquisition. The **Cash – Stock** row is the formal cash-specificity test (Wald on the coefficient difference) the side-by-side placebo never ran. * $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$; the two pre-announce rows one-tailed ($\beta > 0$), the Cash – Stock row two-tailed. Standard errors in parentheses. For UncResCEO the cash run-up is robust and the cash–stock difference is significant, but that significance rides on the imprecise, theory-unpredicted negative stock estimate (small N_{stock}): read it as supported-but-fragile, not settled. CashRatio (col 2) is not cash-specific, as expected — the claim concerns the uncertainty response, not cash levels.